

Assignment 2 - Worksheet

Social Media and Network Analysis (COSC 2671 / COSC 3047)

Postgraduate Group 42

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1. Project Plan

Aim

Analyse five AI-focused subreddits (r/MachineLearning, r/LocalLLaMA, r/ChatGPT, r/artificial, r/OpenAI) around three 2024 model releases (Llama 3, GPT-4o, Claude 3.5 Sonnet). Use VADER sentiment and LDA topics on posts/comments, and co-comment networks (pre / peak / post windows) to compare how communities differ in tone, themes, and interaction structure.

Roles

Member	Responsibility	Backup
Vihang Mehere (s4149812, leader)	PullPush collection, pipeline, config, report structure (intro, methods, limitations)	NLP / networks
Siddhant Kripal (s4184755)	Preprocessing checks, VADER/LDA, networks, figures, results & discussion	Collection / integration

Timeline

Week	Milestone	Owner
8	Team formed, topic agreed, repo + config.yaml	All
9	Reddit data collection (PullPush), raw CSVs	Vihang
10	Preprocessing, sentiment, LDA topics	Siddhant
11	Co-comment networks, figures, report draft	Both
12	Revision, GitHub push, Canvas submission	All

Communication

- Met twice weekly on Microsoft Teams; day-to-day coordination in group chat.
- Shared code and outputs via GitHub (https://github.com/Vihang30/SMNA_Group42); commit history tracked progress.

2. Weekly Timesheets

Siddhant Kripal (s4184755)

Week	Tasks	Hours	Notes
Week 8	Background reading, subreddit list, success criteria	4	
Week 9	Text cleaning checks, VADER trials on sample text	6	
Week 10	LDA (8 topics), sentiment tables by release/phase	9	Topic labelling
Week 11	Network metrics, Louvain plots, report Sections 9–13	11	
Week 12	Proofread report, final pipeline run, worksheet	5	

3. Self-Reflection

Siddhant

I ran VADER sentiment and LDA, then built the co-comment networks and report figures. Topic 0 (bot/moderation language) reminded me that LDA on Reddit needs careful interpretation, not just top-word lists. High modularity post-release was interesting to link with more fragmented discussion.

Vihang kept the pipeline stable so I could rerun NLP and networks quickly after config changes. We split results writing by section to avoid duplicate work.

Main challenge: thin data for some release × phase cells — had to avoid over-claiming in the discussion. I would add more manual VADER spot-checks next time.

Estimated contribution: Siddhant ~50%, Vihang ~50% — balanced workload.